not complaining. I am very fortunate in many ways. But Dan and I know we always have to plan well and make sacrifices to ensure we see enough of each other.

Gary Kirsten once told me how, facing similar challenges, he and his wife, Debbie, introduced a 21-day rule, whereby they would never go longer than 21 days without seeing each other. It meant that, if he was on tour for more than three weeks, she would fly in to visit him, whatever the cost.

They made a decision that seeing each other regularly had to be the highest priority in their lives, and Danielle and I have reached the same conclusion, although we are trying to apply a 10-day rule.

We were separated for the entire eight weeks of the IPL in 2015, and it was tough. Speaking several times a day on Skype is no substitute. In 2016, whenever possible, she and AB junior travelled with me. Living in a hotel is not ideal, but at least we are all together.

I try not to bring cricket home and work hard to be equally as considerate and helpful whether I have scored a century or been out for a duck, whether everything is going well inside the team or whether there are issues that are bothering me, whether we have won or lost.

Danielle always manages to be incredibly supportive, whatever the situation. She has never been a huge follower of the game, which is probably a good thing, but she says precisely the right things to give me confidence when I leave in the morning and is always sympathetic and understanding when I return at the end of the day.

The pressure does occasionally take its toll and, on several occasions in recent years, I have struggled to sleep properly. Some people can get by with just a few hours of rest. I am not one of them. I need a minimum of eight hours of sleep each night, or life can start to become challenging.

I remember getting absolutely no sleep at all on the night before the first day of the second Test against India in Durban in December 2013. I went to bed around 10 pm, as usual, but could not sleep. My wife was